Still Here: Quick Guide

AI offers possible words. The person decides what to say.

Hold a conversation using only eyebrows and blinks. Runs as an iPad app and in a browser.

1. Start (helper, about 1 minute)

1. Open **Still Here**. Landscape, at eye level, **50-70 cm** from the face, with light on the face.
2. First time only: iPadOS asks for **camera** and **microphone**. Tap **Allow**. Volume up, silent mode off.
3. The launch card says **"Ready when you are"** and shows the defaults: eyebrows to move, long blink to choose; speaks as soon as you choose; live AI suggestions, natural voice.
4. Tap the big **Start** button:
   - **Start with saved calibration** if the person is already calibrated.
   - Otherwise **Next: set up eyebrow + blink control**. Short calibration: relax, raise eyebrows a few times, practice, natural blinks, long deliberate blinks, review timing, practice selecting.
5. Other ways to choose (auto-scan with blink, keyboard or switch, touch) are under **Other ways to choose**. Privacy, context and profile are under **More options**.

2. The gestures

Do this	It does this
Raise both eyebrows (about 0.35-0.5 s)	**Next**: move one choice
Keep eyebrows up	**Keep moving**: a step every 0.6 s. Relax to stop
Brief jaw drop (about 0.4-1.5 s, then close)	**Back**: one choice back. Talking and yawns are ignored
Long blink (about 1 s, deliberate)	**Select**: the reply is spoken right away
Long blink while it is speaking	**Stop** speaking
Normal blinking	Nothing. Ignored.
Face lost, look back, long blink on Resume	Continue after a pause

On screen: **Eyebrows up: Next. Jaw drop: Back. Long blink: Select.** Blink always wins. Hold timing is set in calibration. *Hold-to-move and jaw drop: deployed, unit-tested; not yet on the iPad.*

3. Having a conversation

1. **Partner:** just talk near the iPad. What you say is transcribed and becomes the **"Partner asked"** line automatically.
2. A few seconds later, the **2 most likely replies** appear, then **Other ways to answer…**. The **top one is already highlighted**.
3. **Person:** one **long blink** speaks it in a natural voice. Or raise eyebrows to move to another reply, **Other ways to answer…**, **None of these: new suggestions**, **Guide my response**, **Quick phrases**, **My words**, or **More tools**.
4. Listening pauses while Still Here speaks, then resumes. If the partner says more within about 20 s ("Are you coming to dinner?" then "It's at seven"), it joins the same question and the suggestions refresh, highlight back on top; the person is not pulled out of menus. Lines heard while Still Here speaks or a dialog is open wait and are answered right after. After about 20 s, a new line starts a new question.
5. Pure filler alone ("uh huh", "mm-hmm", "hmm", "got it") is ignored. Short answers like "yeah", "okay" or "sure", and "Yes?", "No." and "Hey", still count.

What is on the screen

Left: the conversation

- Big **"Partner asked"** text
- 2 likely replies (top one highlighted), then **Other ways to answer…**
- **None of these: new suggestions**
- Action row: **Guide my response**, **Quick phrases**, **My words**, **More tools**

Right: camera and chat

- Live **camera preview** (not recorded) and a gesture feedback line
- **Conversation** panel with chat bubbles
- **"Listening: just talk"** and a **Stop listening** button
- **Type or record instead** for typing or Talk

Good to know

- **Other ways to answer** (setup checkbox, on by default): the card previews 3-5 directions, e.g. Rough day, Mixed day, Not now, You first. Choose it for direction cards plus **Something else. New ideas** and **Back**. Replies for every direction load in the background, so a direction usually shows 3 ready replies at once (trail: **Other ways › Rough day**). Open-ended questions can take 7-9 s. *Deployed, unit-tested; not yet on the iPad.*
- **Typeface:** Atkinson Hyperlegible, designed for low-vision legibility.
- **Fast mode (default):** one long blink speaks immediately. Turn it off in setup to add a review step and a separate confirming blink. In fast mode, suggested sentences may be sent to the voice service ahead of time so the chosen one plays instantly.
- **Several faces:** tracking follows the most central face that has been in view longest. Others are ignored.
- **Helper controls: Pause** (top right). **More tools, Controls, Voice** switches to the basic device voice. The helper can always tap answers directly.

If something goes wrong

Problem	Fix
"Face lost" and paused	Look back at the screen, then long blink on **Resume**.
Gestures not picked up	Light on the face, 50-70 cm away, camera at eye level. Glasses glare can confuse it. Recalibrate from setup if needed.
No sound	Volume up, silent mode off. Or **More tools, Controls, Voice** for the basic device voice.
Noisy room picks up other voices	Tap **Stop listening**, then type under **Type or record instead**.
No camera or microphone	Tap **Allow** when asked.
Anything else	Helper taps **Pause** and taps answers directly.

Privacy

- Camera images **stay on the iPad**. Only eyebrow and eye movement is measured. **Nothing is recorded.**
- The partner's speech **is sent for transcription** to make suggestions.
- Suggestions are possibilities. **Nothing is said unless the person chooses it.**

Still Here is an engineering prototype. It is not a medical device.